

THE COMPLETE ENGLISH LANGUAGE ROADMAP

Alphabets se Oxford PhD tak — Harvard · MIT · Oxford · Cambridge Level

Yeh PDF English Language seekhne ka **mukammal ordered roadmap** hai — bilkul shuruaat (letters aur sounds) se lekar Oxford/Cambridge PhD level ke academic writing, literary theory, aur linguistic research tak. Har topic pichle topic ki bunyaad par bana hai. Koi cheez nahi chodi gayi — Phonics se Deconstruction tak sab kuch yahan hai. Yeh list self-learners, parents, aur teachers — sab ke liye hai.

LEVEL	STAGE	TARGET
Level 1	Pre-Literacy (Age 3–5)	Letters, sounds, basic words
Level 2	Early Literacy (Age 5–7)	Reading, writing, basic grammar
Level 3	Primary (Age 7–10)	Fluency, paragraphs, core grammar
Level 4	Lower Secondary (Age 10–13)	Essays, advanced grammar, vocabulary
Level 5	Upper Secondary (Age 13–16)	Literature, formal writing, IGCSE
Level 6	Pre-University (Age 16–18)	A-Level, rhetoric, advanced literature
Level 7	Undergraduate (Age 18–21)	University writing, linguistics, literary theory
Level 8	Graduate / MA (Age 21–24)	Critical theory, research, academic publishing
Level 9	PhD / Research (Age 24+)	Original scholarship, Oxford/Cambridge level

1.1 Print Awareness

- 1.1.1 Understanding that print carries meaning
- 1.1.2 Directionality: left to right, top to bottom
- 1.1.3 Difference between letters, words, and sentences
- 1.1.4 Recognising one's own name in print
- 1.1.5 Book handling: front/back cover, pages, title
- 1.1.6 Author and illustrator — who creates a book

1.2 Phonological Awareness

- 1.2.1 Rhyming: recognising and producing rhymes
- 1.2.2 Syllables: clapping words into parts (cat=1, butter=2)
- 1.2.3 Onset and rime: c-at, h-at, m-at
- 1.2.4 Alliteration: same starting sounds
- 1.2.5 Isolating initial sounds: 'What sound does dog start with?'
- 1.2.6 Isolating final sounds
- 1.2.7 Blending spoken sounds into words: /d/ /o/ /g/ → dog
- 1.2.8 Segmenting words into individual sounds

1.3 Alphabet Knowledge

- 1.3.1 Recognising all 26 uppercase letters
- 1.3.2 Recognising all 26 lowercase letters
- 1.3.3 Writing uppercase letters (print)
- 1.3.4 Writing lowercase letters (print)
- 1.3.5 Alphabetical order — singing and reciting
- 1.3.6 Letter names vs letter sounds
- 1.3.7 Matching uppercase to lowercase

1.4 Oral Language and Listening

- 1.4.1 Following two and three-step oral directions
- 1.4.2 Listening to stories and retelling main events
- 1.4.3 Answering who, what, where questions about a story
- 1.4.4 Vocabulary: learning 2–4 new words daily from conversation
- 1.4.5 Speaking in complete sentences
- 1.4.6 Describing objects, people, events
- 1.4.7 Asking and answering questions
- 1.4.8 Turn-taking in conversation

★ *Parents: Roz zor se padhna (read-aloud) sabse zyada effective hai. Bacche ko words point karo.*

CHAPTER 2 — EARLY LITERACY (Level 2 | Age 5–7)

2.1 Systematic Phonics

- 2.1.1 Single letter-sound correspondences: a=/a/, b=/b/ ... z=/z/
- 2.1.2 Short vowel sounds: a, e, i, o, u in CVC words
- 2.1.3 Consonant blends (initial): bl, cr, dr, fl, gr, pl, sk, sl, sm, sn, sp, st, sw, tr
- 2.1.4 Consonant blends (final): nd, nt, lk, lp, mp, sk, sp, st
- 2.1.5 Consonant digraphs: ch, sh, th, wh, ph, ng, ck
- 2.1.6 Long vowel patterns: silent-e (cake, bike, hope)
- 2.1.7 Vowel digraphs: ai, ay, ee, ea, oa, ow, oo, ou
- 2.1.8 R-controlled vowels: ar, er, ir, or, ur
- 2.1.9 Diphthongs: oi, oy, ou, ow
- 2.1.10 Soft c and g: city, giant
- 2.1.11 Silent letters: kn, wr, gn, mb
- 2.1.12 Decoding CVC words: cat, bin, hop
- 2.1.13 Decoding CCVC and CVCC words
- 2.1.14 Decoding two-syllable words
- 2.1.15 High-frequency (sight) words — Dolch/Fry list 1–100

2.2 Reading Fluency — Beginning

- 2.2.1 Blending sounds smoothly to read words
- 2.2.2 Re-reading for accuracy
- 2.2.3 Reading decodable books independently
- 2.2.4 Word-by-word vs phrase reading
- 2.2.5 Reading punctuation: pausing at full stop, rising at question mark

2.3 Reading Comprehension — Beginning

- 2.3.1 Identifying main character, setting, problem, solution
- 2.3.2 Sequencing events: first, next, then, last
- 2.3.3 Predicting what happens next
- 2.3.4 Making connections: text-to-self
- 2.3.5 Asking questions while reading
- 2.3.6 Identifying the main idea
- 2.3.7 Literal vs inferential questions
- 2.3.8 Visualising — creating mental pictures
- 2.3.9 Vocabulary in context: using clues to find meaning

2.4 Writing — Beginning

- 2.4.1 Pencil grip and letter formation
- 2.4.2 Writing own name correctly
- 2.4.3 Copying words and simple sentences
- 2.4.4 Inventive/phonetic spelling
- 2.4.5 Writing simple sentences: 'The cat sat on the mat.'
- 2.4.6 Capital letter at start of sentence
- 2.4.7 Full stop at end of sentence
- 2.4.8 Writing labels and captions for pictures
- 2.4.9 Simple list writing
- 2.4.10 Writing two to three connected sentences

2.5 Grammar — Foundational

- 2.5.1 Nouns: common and proper
- 2.5.2 Verbs: action words
- 2.5.3 Adjectives: describing words

- 2.5.4 Singular and plural: cat/cats, box/boxes, child/children
- 2.5.5 Articles: a, an, the
- 2.5.6 Pronouns: I, he, she, it, we, they, me, him, her, us, them
- 2.5.7 Present tense verbs: is, are, have, do
- 2.5.8 Past tense: regular (-ed) and common irregular (went, came, saw)
- 2.5.9 Simple sentence structure: Subject + Verb + Object
- 2.5.10 Questions: using 'is', 'are', 'do', 'does', 'can'

2.6 Vocabulary — Early

- 2.6.1 Colour, number, shape, size words
- 2.6.2 Family and community words
- 2.6.3 Time words: today, yesterday, tomorrow, morning, evening
- 2.6.4 Position words: above, below, beside, between, through
- 2.6.5 Opposites (antonyms): hot/cold, big/small, fast/slow
- 2.6.6 Simple synonyms: big/large, happy/glad
- 2.6.7 Words with multiple meanings: bat, bark, light
- 2.6.8 Compound words: sunshine, football, bedroom

★ *Tip: Dolch sight words ke flashcards banao. Roz 5-10 words practice. Fluency isi se aati hai.*

3.1 Phonics — Advanced and Word Study

- 3.1.1 Multisyllabic word decoding strategies
- 3.1.2 Prefixes: un-, re-, pre-, mis-, dis-, non-, over-, sub-, inter-, trans-
- 3.1.3 Suffixes: -tion, -sion, -ness, -ment, -ful, -less, -ly, -er, -est, -able, -ible
- 3.1.4 Greek and Latin roots: bio, graph, tele, port, rupt, vis, aud
- 3.1.5 Syllabication rules (six syllable types)
- 3.1.6 Spelling rules: doubling consonants, dropping silent-e, changing y to i
- 3.1.7 Homophones: there/their/they're, your/you're, to/too/two
- 3.1.8 Commonly misspelled words — Tier 1 list

3.2 Reading Fluency

- 3.2.1 Oral reading fluency: rate, accuracy, prosody
- 3.2.2 Reading phrases and clauses as units
- 3.2.3 Expression — reading dialogue with voice
- 3.2.4 Self-monitoring and self-correction strategies
- 3.2.5 Silent reading stamina (sustained reading)

3.3 Reading Comprehension — Intermediate

- 3.3.1 Main idea and supporting details
- 3.3.2 Summarising: retelling in own words
- 3.3.3 Inferencing: reading between the lines
- 3.3.4 Author's purpose: to inform, entertain, persuade
- 3.3.5 Fact vs opinion
- 3.3.6 Cause and effect
- 3.3.7 Compare and contrast
- 3.3.8 Character traits — using evidence from text
- 3.3.9 Theme — the central message
- 3.3.10 Point of view: first/third person narration
- 3.3.11 Text features: headings, captions, diagrams, glossary, index
- 3.3.12 Text types: fiction, non-fiction, poetry, drama
- 3.3.13 Making text-to-text and text-to-world connections
- 3.3.14 Evaluating author's choices

3.4 Grammar — Core

- 3.4.1 Parts of speech: noun, verb, adjective, adverb, pronoun, preposition, conjunction, interjection
- 3.4.2 Types of nouns: common, proper, abstract, collective, countable, uncountable
- 3.4.3 Types of pronouns: personal, possessive, reflexive, relative, demonstrative, interrogative
- 3.4.4 Types of verbs: action, linking, helping/auxiliary
- 3.4.5 Verb tenses: simple present, past, future
- 3.4.6 Continuous/progressive tenses: present, past, future
- 3.4.7 Perfect tenses: present perfect, past perfect, future perfect
- 3.4.8 Modal verbs: can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to
- 3.4.9 Subject-verb agreement
- 3.4.10 Adverbs: manner, time, place, frequency, degree
- 3.4.11 Prepositions: time, place, direction, cause
- 3.4.12 Conjunctions: coordinating (FANBOYS), subordinating, correlative
- 3.4.13 Sentence types: simple, compound, complex, compound-complex
- 3.4.14 Phrases: noun phrase, verb phrase, prepositional phrase, adjectival phrase
- 3.4.15 Clauses: independent and dependent
- 3.4.16 Relative clauses: who, which, that, whose, whom
- 3.4.17 Direct and indirect (reported) speech

- 3.4.18 Active and passive voice
- 3.4.19 Degrees of comparison: positive, comparative, superlative

3.5 Punctuation

- 3.5.1 Full stop, question mark, exclamation mark
- 3.5.2 Comma: lists, after introductory phrases, before conjunctions
- 3.5.3 Apostrophe: contraction and possession
- 3.5.4 Inverted commas / quotation marks (direct speech)
- 3.5.5 Colon: introducing a list or explanation
- 3.5.6 Semicolon: linking related independent clauses
- 3.5.7 Hyphen and dash
- 3.5.8 Parentheses / brackets
- 3.5.9 Ellipsis (...)
- 3.5.10 Capital letters: proper nouns, titles, start of sentences

3.6 Writing — Paragraphs and Composition

- 3.6.1 Topic sentence
- 3.6.2 Supporting details / body sentences
- 3.6.3 Concluding sentence
- 3.6.4 Paragraph structure: PIE (Point-Illustration-Explanation)
- 3.6.5 Transition words: first, however, therefore, in conclusion, similarly
- 3.6.6 Narrative writing: plot structure, characters, setting, conflict, resolution
- 3.6.7 Descriptive writing: sensory details, show don't tell
- 3.6.8 Expository / informational writing
- 3.6.9 Opinion writing: stating a position, giving reasons, examples
- 3.6.10 Letter writing: formal and informal
- 3.6.11 Writing process: prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, publishing
- 3.6.12 Peer editing and self-editing checklist

3.7 Vocabulary — Intermediate

- 3.7.1 Tier 2 academic vocabulary: analyse, compare, describe, explain, suggest
- 3.7.2 Context clues strategies: definition, example, contrast, inference
- 3.7.3 Connotation vs denotation
- 3.7.4 Figurative language: simile, metaphor, personification, hyperbole, idiom, onomatopoeia
- 3.7.5 Word families: act, action, active, activate, actor
- 3.7.6 Dictionary and thesaurus skills
- 3.7.7 Using vocabulary in writing

3.8 Poetry — Introduction

- 3.8.1 Rhyme scheme: ABAB, AABB, ABCB
- 3.8.2 Rhythm and meter — basic
- 3.8.3 Types of poems: haiku, limerick, acrostic, free verse, ballad
- 3.8.4 Imagery and sensory language
- 3.8.5 Reading and responding to poetry
- 3.8.6 Writing simple poems

3.9 Speaking and Listening

- 3.9.1 Oral presentations: organising and delivering
- 3.9.2 Active listening strategies
- 3.9.3 Note-taking from spoken text
- 3.9.4 Class discussions: building on others' ideas
- 3.9.5 Debate basics: agreeing and disagreeing politely
- 3.9.6 Using evidence to support spoken argument

★ *Grammar rules sirf rules nahi — real reading aur writing mein use karo. Har rule ke baad examples khud banao.*

4.1 Advanced Grammar

- 4.1.1 Subjunctive mood: If I were, I suggest that he be
- 4.1.2 Conditional sentences: zero, first, second, third, mixed
- 4.1.3 Infinitives: bare, full, split infinitives
- 4.1.4 Gerunds and present participles — functions
- 4.1.5 Participle phrases: The man running the race ...
- 4.1.6 Absolute phrases
- 4.1.7 Noun clauses: I know that he is coming
- 4.1.8 Adverbial clauses: when, because, although, unless, until
- 4.1.9 Appositive phrases
- 4.1.10 Parallel structure in sentences and lists
- 4.1.11 Dangling and misplaced modifiers
- 4.1.12 Sentence variety and sentence combining
- 4.1.13 Elliptical clauses
- 4.1.14 Inversion for emphasis: Never have I seen ...
- 4.1.15 Cleft sentences: It was John who called

4.2 Vocabulary — Advanced

- 4.2.1 Etymology: Greek roots (auto, bio, chron, dem, geo, graph, hydr, log, meter, micro, phil, phon, photo, poly, psych, scope, tele, therm)
- 4.2.2 Latin roots (aud, bene, cap, dict, duc, fac, fer, ject, jud, mal, mit, mov, nomen, port, rupt, scrib, spec, tract, ven, vers, vid, voc)
- 4.2.3 French and Norman borrowings in English
- 4.2.4 Academic Word List (AWL) — all 570 words
- 4.2.5 Collocations: make a decision, take a risk, do homework
- 4.2.6 Phrasal verbs: give up, look into, carry out, put forward
- 4.2.7 Idiomatic expressions — common British and American idioms
- 4.2.8 Register: formal, informal, neutral, slang, technical
- 4.2.9 Euphemisms and political language
- 4.2.10 Vocabulary for argumentation: however, nevertheless, conversely, consequently

4.3 Reading — Literature

- 4.3.1 Novel study: setting, character development, plot arc
- 4.3.2 Dramatic irony, situational irony, verbal irony
- 4.3.3 Foreshadowing and flashback
- 4.3.4 Symbolism and motif
- 4.3.5 Conflict: person vs person, vs self, vs society, vs nature
- 4.3.6 Protagonist and antagonist
- 4.3.7 Flat and round characters; static and dynamic
- 4.3.8 Narrative perspective: first, second, third person, omniscient, limited
- 4.3.9 Mood and atmosphere
- 4.3.10 Tone: author's attitude
- 4.3.11 Reading drama: stage directions, dialogue, soliloquy
- 4.3.12 Reading non-fiction: biographies, speeches, articles, essays
- 4.3.13 Evaluating sources: bias, reliability, credibility
- 4.3.14 Comparing texts: form, structure, language, purpose

4.4 Writing — Essay Types

- 4.4.1 Five-paragraph essay structure
- 4.4.2 Introduction: hook, background, thesis statement
- 4.4.3 Thesis statement: arguable, specific, evidence-based

- 4.4.4 Body paragraph: TEEL / PEEL structure
- 4.4.5 Conclusion: restate thesis, synthesise, clincher
- 4.4.6 Argumentative / persuasive essay
- 4.4.7 Compare and contrast essay (block and point-by-point)
- 4.4.8 Cause and effect essay
- 4.4.9 Narrative / personal essay
- 4.4.10 Descriptive essay
- 4.4.11 Process / how-to essay
- 4.4.12 Literary analysis paragraph (basic)
- 4.4.13 Using textual evidence: introducing, quoting, explaining
- 4.4.14 Paraphrasing and summarising sources
- 4.4.15 Avoiding plagiarism — basic citation

4.5 Rhetoric and Persuasive Techniques

- 4.5.1 Ethos, Pathos, Logos (Aristotle's appeals)
- 4.5.2 Rhetorical questions
- 4.5.3 Repetition and anaphora
- 4.5.4 Rule of three (tricolon)
- 4.5.5 Emotive language
- 4.5.6 Statistics and evidence
- 4.5.7 Counter-argument and rebuttal
- 4.5.8 Propaganda techniques: bandwagon, fear appeal, loaded language
- 4.5.9 Analysing advertisements and speeches

4.6 Media and Information Literacy

- 4.6.1 Distinguishing fact from opinion in media
- 4.6.2 Recognising bias in news sources
- 4.6.3 Understanding media purpose: inform, persuade, entertain
- 4.6.4 Digital literacy: evaluating websites
- 4.6.5 Understanding headlines and subheadings
- 4.6.6 Reading infographics and data visualisations
- 4.6.7 Understanding point of view in news

CHAPTER 5 — UPPER SECONDARY (Level 5 | Age 13–16 | IGCSE Level)

5.1 Literature — Prose

- 5.1.1 Close reading and textual analysis
- 5.1.2 Writer's craft: diction, syntax, imagery, tone, voice
- 5.1.3 Narrative structure: linear, non-linear, circular, episodic
- 5.1.4 Gothic, Victorian, Modernist, Postcolonial fiction — introduction
- 5.1.5 Short story conventions: epiphany, in medias res, framing device
- 5.1.6 Novel study — extended analysis
- 5.1.7 Character motivation and psychological depth
- 5.1.8 Historical and cultural context in fiction
- 5.1.9 Intertextuality — basic

5.2 Literature — Poetry

- 5.2.1 Poetic form: sonnet (Petrarchan and Shakespearean), ode, elegy, ballad, villanelle, ghazal, pantoum
- 5.2.2 Meter: iambic, trochaic, spondaic, dactylic, anapestic
- 5.2.3 Iambic pentameter
- 5.2.4 Enjambment and caesura
- 5.2.5 Poetic devices: alliteration, assonance, consonance, sibilance
- 5.2.6 Extended metaphor and conceit
- 5.2.7 Apostrophe (poetic address), pathetic fallacy
- 5.2.8 Volta in a sonnet
- 5.2.9 Free verse — analysis
- 5.2.10 Comparing poems: theme, form, language, context
- 5.2.11 Reading war poetry, nature poetry, love poetry, protest poetry

5.3 Literature — Drama

- 5.3.1 Dramatic structure: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, denouement
- 5.3.2 Shakespearean language: thee, thou, hath, dost, wherefore
- 5.3.3 Soliloquy, aside, monologue, dialogue
- 5.3.4 Tragic hero — hamartia, hubris, nemesis, catharsis
- 5.3.5 Comic conventions: mistaken identity, puns, timing
- 5.3.6 Stage directions and dramatic effect
- 5.3.7 Historical context of Shakespeare
- 5.3.8 Modern drama: absurdism, naturalism

5.4 Advanced Writing

- 5.4.1 Literary analysis essay — IGCSE level
- 5.4.2 Comparative essay: two texts
- 5.4.3 Discursive writing: balanced discussion
- 5.4.4 Report writing: formal structure, headings, recommendations
- 5.4.5 Speech writing: audience awareness, rhetorical devices
- 5.4.6 Newspaper article and magazine feature
- 5.4.7 Review writing: books, films, restaurants
- 5.4.8 Formal and informal email / letter
- 5.4.9 Creative writing: extended narrative
- 5.4.10 Writing for different audiences and purposes
- 5.4.11 Editing for style, precision, concision
- 5.4.12 Vocabulary elevation: replacing weak words

5.5 Language Analysis — IGCSE Skills

- 5.5.1 Identifying and explaining language techniques

- 5.5.2 Analysing effect on the reader
- 5.5.3 PEE / PEEL / PETER framework
- 5.5.4 Understanding implied meaning and connotation
- 5.5.5 Structural analysis: how a text is organised
- 5.5.6 Audience, purpose, form (APF) framework
- 5.5.7 Evaluating a writer's effectiveness
- 5.5.8 Selecting and synthesising information from multiple texts

5.6 Grammar — Mastery Level

- 5.6.1 All 12 verb tenses — form and use
- 5.6.2 Aspect: simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous
- 5.6.3 All conditional types including mixed conditionals
- 5.6.4 Advanced passive constructions: It is believed that ...
- 5.6.5 Nominalisation: 'the destruction of' instead of 'they destroyed'
- 5.6.6 Hedging language: appears to, seems likely, may suggest
- 5.6.7 Formal sentence structures for academic writing
- 5.6.8 Avoiding common errors: its/it's, affect/effect, fewer/less, who/whom
- 5.6.9 Punctuation — mastery of all marks

★ *IGCSE English First Language aur Literature examinations — Cambridge past papers zaroor practice karo.*

6.1 Literary Criticism — Introduction to Critical Schools

- 6.1.1 New Criticism / Formalism — close reading, the text itself
- 6.1.2 Historical criticism — context and background
- 6.1.3 Biographical criticism
- 6.1.4 Marxist criticism — class, ideology, power
- 6.1.5 Feminist criticism — gender, patriarchy
- 6.1.6 Psychoanalytic criticism — Freud, unconscious, id/ego/superego
- 6.1.7 Archetypal criticism — Jung, myth, universal symbols
- 6.1.8 Reader-response criticism — the reader's role
- 6.1.9 Postcolonial criticism — empire, identity, the Other
- 6.1.10 Ecocriticism — nature, environment

6.2 Literature — Canon and Genres

- 6.2.1 Chaucer and Middle English literature (overview)
- 6.2.2 Renaissance and Elizabethan literature
- 6.2.3 Shakespeare: Tragedies, Comedies, Histories, Sonnets — analysis
- 6.2.4 Metaphysical poets: Donne, Herbert, Marvell
- 6.2.5 Restoration and 18th century: Dryden, Pope, Swift, Johnson
- 6.2.6 Romantic movement: Blake, Wordsworth, Coleridge, Keats, Shelley, Byron
- 6.2.7 Victorian literature: Dickens, Eliot, Hardy, Brontës, Tennyson
- 6.2.8 Naturalism and Realism
- 6.2.9 Modernism: Woolf, Joyce, Eliot, Pound, Yeats
- 6.2.10 American literature: Whitman, Dickinson, Faulkner, Hemingway, Fitzgerald
- 6.2.11 Postwar and contemporary: Beckett, Orwell, Heaney, Hughes, Plath
- 6.2.12 World literature in English: Achebe, Rushdie, Achebe, Morrison, Ondaatje
- 6.2.13 Genre fiction: Gothic, dystopia, magical realism — literary analysis

6.3 Advanced Writing — A-Level

- 6.3.1 Extended literary essay (1500–2000 words)
- 6.3.2 Unseen passage analysis
- 6.3.3 Comparative essay — two texts from different periods
- 6.3.4 Coursework essay: independent reading and research
- 6.3.5 Integrating critical perspectives into essays
- 6.3.6 Writing with a critical voice
- 6.3.7 Academic vocabulary and elevated diction
- 6.3.8 Footnotes, endnotes, bibliography — MLA and Harvard styles
- 6.3.9 Argumentative precision: qualifications, concessions, counter-claims
- 6.3.10 Original creative writing: pastiche, parody, transformative writing

6.4 Rhetoric and Linguistics — Introduction

- 6.4.1 History of rhetoric: Aristotle, Cicero, Quintilian
- 6.4.2 Classical rhetorical figures: anaphora, epistrophe, chiasmus, asyndeton, polysyndeton, zeugma, litotes, antithesis, oxymoron, paradox
- 6.4.3 Logos, ethos, pathos — advanced analysis
- 6.4.4 Toulmin model of argument: claim, grounds, warrant, backing, qualifier, rebuttal
- 6.4.5 Logical fallacies: ad hominem, straw man, false dilemma, appeal to authority, slippery slope, post hoc
- 6.4.6 Discourse analysis: spoken vs written language
- 6.4.7 Introduction to linguistics: phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics, pragmatics
- 6.4.8 Language change over time
- 6.4.9 Language and power — Fairclough, critical discourse analysis
- 6.4.10 Gender and language — Lakoff, Cameron

6.4.11 World Englishes: varieties, dialects, creoles

6.4.12 Standard English vs non-standard varieties

6.4.13 Register, style, idiolect, sociolect

★ *A-Level English Literature: Cambridge, Oxford, AQA, Edexcel boards — past paper practice essential. Critical readings likho.*

7.1 Academic Writing — University Level

- 7.1.1 Essay structure at university level: argument-driven
- 7.1.2 Thesis statement: complex, nuanced, contestable
- 7.1.3 Integrating secondary sources critically
- 7.1.4 Avoiding summary; prioritising analysis and interpretation
- 7.1.5 Paragraph coherence: topic sentence, development, link
- 7.1.6 Signposting language for academic essays
- 7.1.7 Citation systems: MLA 9th, APA 7th, Chicago/Turabian, Harvard, OSCOLA
- 7.1.8 Bibliography and works cited — perfect formatting
- 7.1.9 Annotated bibliography
- 7.1.10 Literature review writing
- 7.1.11 Research essay (2000–4000 words)
- 7.1.12 Dissertation / long essay structure (10,000+ words)
- 7.1.13 Writing abstracts
- 7.1.14 Academic email and professional communication
- 7.1.15 Reflective writing: learning journals, portfolios

7.2 Introduction to Linguistics

- 7.2.1 Phonetics: IPA (International Phonetic Alphabet) — all symbols
- 7.2.2 Articulatory phonetics: place and manner of articulation
- 7.2.3 Phonology: phonemes, allophones, minimal pairs
- 7.2.4 Morphology: morphemes, free and bound, derivational and inflectional
- 7.2.5 Word formation: affixation, compounding, blending, clipping, back-formation, conversion, acronym, eponym
- 7.2.6 Syntax: phrase structure rules, X-bar theory (introduction)
- 7.2.7 Syntactic trees (phrase structure diagrams)
- 7.2.8 Semantics: sense, reference, truth conditions
- 7.2.9 Lexical semantics: synonymy, antonymy, hyponymy, polysemy, homonymy
- 7.2.10 Pragmatics: speech act theory — Austin, Searle
- 7.2.11 Grice's Cooperative Principle and conversational maxims
- 7.2.12 Implicature — conventional and conversational
- 7.2.13 Deixis: person, place, time
- 7.2.14 Discourse analysis: cohesion, coherence
- 7.2.15 Sociolinguistics: dialect, register, code-switching
- 7.2.16 Language acquisition: behaviourist, nativist (Chomsky), interactionist
- 7.2.17 Universal Grammar and the Language Acquisition Device (LAD)
- 7.2.18 First language acquisition stages
- 7.2.19 Second language acquisition theories
- 7.2.20 Corpus linguistics: concordancers, frequency lists, collocations

7.3 Literary Theory — Core

- 7.3.1 Russian Formalism: defamiliarisation (Shklovsky), literariness
- 7.3.2 Prague Linguistic Circle: foregrounding, markedness
- 7.3.3 New Criticism: close reading, intentional fallacy (Wimsatt & Beardsley), affective fallacy
- 7.3.4 Structuralism: Saussure — sign, signifier, signified, arbitrariness
- 7.3.5 Structuralist narratology: Propp's morphology, Greimas's actantial model
- 7.3.6 Narratology: Genette — narrative time (order, duration, frequency), voice, mood
- 7.3.7 Todorov's narrative theory
- 7.3.8 Semiotics: Peirce — icon, index, symbol
- 7.3.9 Barthes: myth, codes, 'Death of the Author'
- 7.3.10 Deconstruction: Derrida — différance, trace, aporia, logocentrism
- 7.3.11 Post-structuralism and the instability of meaning

- 7.3.12 Psychoanalytic theory: Lacan — mirror stage, Imaginary/Symbolic/Real
- 7.3.13 Marxist theory: Althusser — ideological state apparatus, interpellation
- 7.3.14 Gramsci: hegemony
- 7.3.15 Feminist theory: Simone de Beauvoir, Betty Friedan, Elaine Showalter
- 7.3.16 French feminism: Irigaray, Cixous (écriture féminine), Kristeva
- 7.3.17 Gender studies: Butler — performativity, gender as construction
- 7.3.18 Postcolonial theory: Said — Orientalism, discourse of colonialism
- 7.3.19 Bhabha: hybridity, mimicry, the third space
- 7.3.20 Spivak: the subaltern, strategic essentialism

7.4 History of the English Language

- 7.4.1 Proto-Indo-European origins
- 7.4.2 Germanic branches and Old English (Anglo-Saxon) period
- 7.4.3 Old English grammar: case system, strong/weak verbs
- 7.4.4 Old English texts: Beowulf, Anglo-Saxon Chronicle
- 7.4.5 Viking influence: Danelaw, Norse borrowings
- 7.4.6 Norman Conquest 1066: French and Latin influence
- 7.4.7 Middle English period: Chaucer, dialectal variation
- 7.4.8 Great Vowel Shift (1400–1700)
- 7.4.9 Early Modern English: Shakespeare, KJV Bible
- 7.4.10 Standardisation: Johnson's Dictionary, Lowth's Grammar
- 7.4.11 Modern English: industrialisation, scientific vocabulary
- 7.4.12 American English: history and divergence
- 7.4.13 Contemporary English: globalisation, internet language
- 7.4.14 Language change processes: broadening, narrowing, amelioration, pejoration

7.5 Genre and Form — Advanced Literary Study

- 7.5.1 The novel: rise of the form, realism, Bakhtin's dialogism
- 7.5.2 Epic poetry: Homer, Virgil, Milton — Paradise Lost close study
- 7.5.3 Lyric poetry: traditions and transformations
- 7.5.4 Tragedy: Aristotle's Poetics, Shakespearean tragedy, modern tragedy
- 7.5.5 Comedy: theories of comedy — Bergson, Freud
- 7.5.6 The short story: Poe's unity of effect, Chekhov's gun
- 7.5.7 Life writing: autobiography, memoir, biography — Philippe Lejeune
- 7.5.8 Creative non-fiction: New Journalism, essay tradition — Montaigne, Woolf
- 7.5.9 Gothic literature: conventions, the uncanny (Freud), the abject (Kristeva)
- 7.5.10 Science fiction: utopia, dystopia, speculative fiction
- 7.5.11 Postmodernist fiction: metafiction, intertextuality, unreliable narrator
- 7.5.12 Children's literature: ideology, implied reader (Aidan Chambers)

★ *Oxford/Cambridge interview prep: Be ready to do unseen close reading of any text. Read widely and think critically.*

8.1 Advanced Literary Theory

- 8.1.1 New Historicism: Foucault — discourse, power/knowledge, genealogy
- 8.1.2 Foucault: The Order of Things, Discipline and Punish — literary applications
- 8.1.3 Cultural Materialism: Raymond Williams — base/superstructure, structures of feeling
- 8.1.4 Cultural Studies: Stuart Hall — representation, encoding/decoding
- 8.1.5 Queer Theory: Eve Sedgwick — homosocial desire, the closet
- 8.1.6 Queer Theory: Butler — heteronormativity, gender trouble
- 8.1.7 Disability Studies: crip theory, ableism in texts
- 8.1.8 Affect theory: Massumi, Sedgwick — feeling, sensation in literature
- 8.1.9 Ecocriticism and the Blue Humanities
- 8.1.10 Animal studies and posthumanism
- 8.1.11 Cognitive literary theory: Theory of Mind, narrative empathy
- 8.1.12 Digital humanities: text mining, distant reading (Moretti)
- 8.1.13 World literature theory: Casanova, Damrosch, Moretti
- 8.1.14 Translation studies: Venuti — foreignisation and domestication
- 8.1.15 Reception theory: Jauss — horizon of expectations; Iser — the implied reader

8.2 Advanced Linguistics

- 8.2.1 Formal syntax: Government and Binding, Minimalist Program (Chomsky)
- 8.2.2 Generative grammar: deep structure vs surface structure
- 8.2.3 Optimality Theory
- 8.2.4 Functional grammar: Halliday's Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL)
- 8.2.5 Metafunctions: ideational, interpersonal, textual
- 8.2.6 Critical Discourse Analysis: Fairclough, van Dijk, Wodak
- 8.2.7 Conversation Analysis: turn-taking, adjacency pairs, repair
- 8.2.8 Interactional Sociolinguistics: Goffman — face, footing
- 8.2.9 Politeness theory: Brown and Levinson — positive and negative face
- 8.2.10 Language and identity: identity construction in discourse
- 8.2.11 Multimodality: Kress and van Leeuwen — visual grammar
- 8.2.12 Cognitive linguistics: prototype theory, conceptual metaphor (Lakoff and Johnson)
- 8.2.13 Frame semantics: Fillmore
- 8.2.14 Construction grammar
- 8.2.15 Computational linguistics: parsing, tagging, NLP basics
- 8.2.16 Phonological theory: autosegmental phonology, metrical phonology
- 8.2.17 Language typology and universals
- 8.2.18 Historical linguistics: reconstruction, sound changes, comparative method
- 8.2.19 Bilingualism and multilingualism
- 8.2.20 Language endangerment and documentation

8.3 Research Methods in English Studies

- 8.3.1 Qualitative vs quantitative research in linguistics
- 8.3.2 Ethnographic methods in language research
- 8.3.3 Interview and discourse data collection
- 8.3.4 Corpus design and analysis
- 8.3.5 Survey design for language research
- 8.3.6 Literary research methodology
- 8.3.7 Archival research
- 8.3.8 Manuscript studies and textual editing
- 8.3.9 Book history and the history of reading
- 8.3.10 Ethical considerations in research
- 8.3.11 Writing a research proposal

8.3.12 MA dissertation: from question to submission

8.4 Comparative Literature

- 8.4.1 What is comparative literature? — history and debates
- 8.4.2 Methodologies: influence studies, parallel studies, thematic
- 8.4.3 Translation as interpretation
- 8.4.4 Francophone, Lusophone, Hispanophone literatures
- 8.4.5 African literature in English: Achebe, Soyinka, Ngugi, Adichie
- 8.4.6 South Asian literature in English: Rushdie, Roy, Desai, Ghosh
- 8.4.7 Caribbean literature: Walcott, Kincaid, Naipaul
- 8.4.8 Australian, Canadian, New Zealand literatures
- 8.4.9 Diasporic writing and exile literature
- 8.4.10 Myth and literature across cultures: Campbell's Hero's Journey

8.5 Academic Publishing and Professional Practice

- 8.5.1 Reading and writing journal articles in humanities
- 8.5.2 Peer review process — how it works
- 8.5.3 Conference paper writing and presenting
- 8.5.4 Grant and fellowship applications
- 8.5.5 Book review writing for academic journals
- 8.5.6 Editing a scholarly volume
- 8.5.7 Understanding the academic job market
- 8.5.8 Teaching English in higher education
- 8.5.9 Public writing: journalism, criticism, essays for general audience

CHAPTER 9 — PhD / RESEARCH FRONTIER (Level 9 | Oxford · Cambridge · Harvard)

Ye wo topics hain jahan original scholarship hoti hai. Oxford aur Cambridge DPhil, Harvard PhD in English — yahan candidates naya knowledge create karte hain. Kisi ek area mein deep specialisation, plus mastery of relevant theory and method.

9.1 Dissertation / Thesis

- 9.1.1 Identifying a research gap in existing scholarship
- 9.1.2 Developing an original, defensible argument
- 9.1.3 Comprehensive literature review (30–50+ sources)
- 9.1.4 Chapter architecture and argument progression
- 9.1.5 Writing 80,000–100,000 words of sustained academic prose
- 9.1.6 Oral examination (viva voce) — defending thesis
- 9.1.7 Revisions and corrections post-viva
- 9.1.8 Transforming thesis into monograph

9.2 Specialisation Areas — Literary Studies

- 9.2.1 Medieval studies: manuscript culture, codicology, palaeography
- 9.2.2 Early Modern Studies: textual bibliography, book history
- 9.2.3 Romanticism: archival research, manuscript studies
- 9.2.4 Victorian studies: periodical culture, social problem fiction
- 9.2.5 Modernism: little magazines, expatriate networks, little presses
- 9.2.6 Contemporary fiction: genre studies, publishing industry
- 9.2.7 Poetry studies: prosody research, little magazine archives
- 9.2.8 Drama studies: performance theory, stage history, promptbooks
- 9.2.9 Postcolonial and decolonial literary studies
- 9.2.10 Gender and sexuality studies in literature
- 9.2.11 Race and ethnic studies in Anglophone literature
- 9.2.12 Environmental humanities and climate fiction
- 9.2.13 Law and literature
- 9.2.14 Medicine and literature: medical humanities
- 9.2.15 Religion and literature

9.3 Specialisation Areas — Linguistics

- 9.3.1 Phonological theory: advanced formal models
- 9.3.2 Syntactic theory: Minimalism — latest developments
- 9.3.3 Semantics: formal semantics — model-theoretic, Montague grammar
- 9.3.4 Pragmatics: experimental pragmatics, relevance theory (Sperber and Wilson)
- 9.3.5 Sociolinguistics: variation theory, Labovian methods
- 9.3.6 Language change: grammaticalisation theory
- 9.3.7 Corpus linguistics: advanced computational methods
- 9.3.8 Psycholinguistics: language processing, eye-tracking, EEG studies
- 9.3.9 Neurolinguistics: Broca's and Wernicke's areas, aphasia research
- 9.3.10 Computational linguistics: NLP, machine translation, LLM linguistics
- 9.3.11 Applied linguistics: second language acquisition research
- 9.3.12 Language policy and language planning research
- 9.3.13 Endangered languages: fieldwork and documentation
- 9.3.14 Sign language linguistics

9.4 Critical Theory — Advanced and Emerging

- 9.4.1 Biopolitics and biopower: Foucault, Agamben — bare life, state of exception
- 9.4.2 Speculative realism and object-oriented ontology (OOO) in literary studies

- 9.4.3 New materialism: Barad — agential realism, intra-action
- 9.4.4 Decolonial theory: Quijano, Mignolo — coloniality of power
- 9.4.5 Afropessimism: Wilderson — anti-Blackness, social death
- 9.4.6 Accelerationism and its literary manifestations
- 9.4.7 Psychoanalysis and literature: Žižek — ideology, the Real
- 9.4.8 Deleuze and Guattari: rhizome, deterritorialisation, becoming-minor
- 9.4.9 Rancière: the distribution of the sensible, politics of literature
- 9.4.10 Nancy: community, singular plural being
- 9.4.11 Badiou: truth procedures, the event
- 9.4.12 Agamben: potentiality, language and death
- 9.4.13 Mbembe: necropolitics, Afropolitanism
- 9.4.14 Temporality studies: hauntology (Derrida/Fisher), anachronism

9.5 Digital Humanities at Research Level

- 9.5.1 Text encoding: TEI (Text Encoding Initiative)
- 9.5.2 Digital scholarly editing
- 9.5.3 Distant reading methodologies: topic modelling, word vectors
- 9.5.4 Network analysis in literary history
- 9.5.5 GIS (Geographic Information Systems) in literary research
- 9.5.6 Stylometry and authorship attribution
- 9.5.7 Computational approaches to metre and rhyme
- 9.5.8 Building digital archives and databases
- 9.5.9 LLMs and literary analysis — promises and problems
- 9.5.10 Open access and the future of humanities publishing

9.6 Pedagogy — Teaching English at University

- 9.6.1 Theories of reading pedagogy
- 9.6.2 Teaching writing: process and genre approaches
- 9.6.3 Teaching literature: canon debates, diversity
- 9.6.4 EFL/ESOL pedagogy: CLT, task-based learning
- 9.6.5 Academic literacy development
- 9.6.6 Assessment design in English studies
- 9.6.7 Technology in the English classroom

COMPLETE ROADMAP — AT A GLANCE

Chapter	Level	Age / Stage	Focus Areas	Topics
1	L1	Age 3–5	Pre-Literacy: Phonological awareness, alphabet	~45
2	L2	Age 5–7	Phonics, early reading, basic grammar	~90
3	L3	Age 7–10	Fluency, paragraphs, core grammar, vocab	~105
4	L4	Age 10–13	Advanced grammar, rhetoric, essay writing	~80
5	L5	Age 13–16	Literature (prose/poetry/drama), IGCSE	~90
6	L6	Age 16–18	A-Level: criticism, literary history, linguistics intro	~80
7	L7	Age 18–21	University writing, linguistics, literary theory	~120
8	L8	Age 21–24	Advanced theory, MA research, comparative lit	~100
9	L9	Age 24+	PhD research, specialisation, frontier theory	~90
TOTAL				~800+ Topics

Yeh roadmap Cambridge IGCSE, A-Level, Oxford DPhil, Cambridge DPhil, Harvard PhD English aur Linguistics syllabi ke mutabiq tayyar kiya gaya hai. Alphabets se Derrida tak — har ek topic is sequence mein rakha gaya hai.
Mehnat karo, sab mumkin hai.